

Philosophy and literature



A distinctively French approach to philosophy developed in the late 19th century from France's rich literary culture. It was partly influenced by the literary style of philosophers such as Schopenhauer and Nietzsche, and also by the subjective stance of emergent existentialism. In the work of Henri Bergson, the boundary between philosophy and literature was not always clear – indeed, he won the 1927 Nobel Prize in Literature for his philosophical writing. Others, such as Jean-Paul Sartre and Albert Camus, expressed their philosophical ideas in works of literature, popularizing existentialism after the Second World War. Literary criticism also played a

part in shaping 20th-century French philosophy, as did the growing fields of linguistics and semiotics (see [Linguistics and semiotics](#) and [Structuralism](#)). Structuralists such as Louis Althusser, Jacques Lacan, Michel Foucault, and Jacques Derrida saw philosophical discourse as nothing more than a structure in language. Both existentialism and structuralism became hugely popular worldwide, but were in distinct contrast to mainstream philosophy elsewhere.